THE PLOT That Went Nowhere

The alleged conspiracy to kill Khalistani leader Gurpatwant Singh Pannun in 2023 was exposed by an indictment filed by the US Department of Justice in a New York court. A chronology of its main charges:

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS**

THE CAST OF CHARACTERS



VIKASH YADAV Main conspirator, alleged to be a former RAW agent



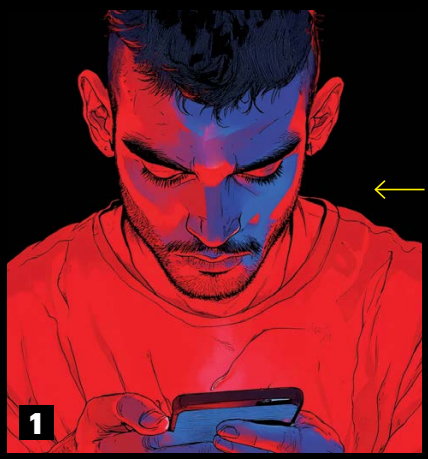
NIKHIL GUPTA Indian national Yadav recruited to plan the hit



CS: Gupta's contact in the US; actually a US law informer



UC: The 'hitman' arranged by CS—undercover US officer



1

MAY 2023

Yadav asks Gupta to arrange Pannun's murder, sends his NY address; money for the hit is set at $100,000



4

JUNE 9 The Indian duo arrange for the UC to be paid an advance of $15,000 in cash via an associate in Manhattan



2

JUNE 3

Gupta engages CS and tells him: "Finish him brother...don't take too much time"

5

JUNE 11

Yadav to Gupta: "We have today only; [else] it will be done after 24th"–post PM Modi's US visit

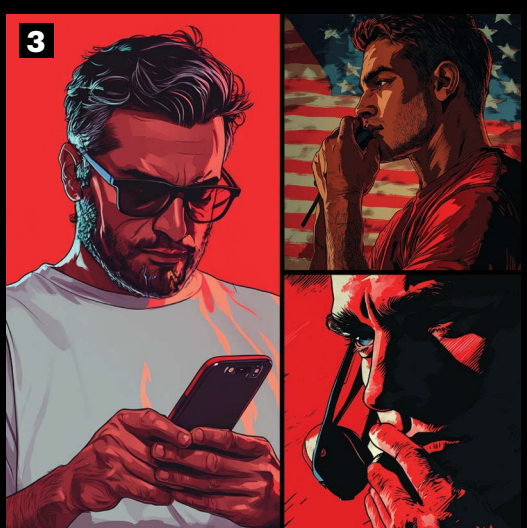




6

JUNE 12-14

Gupta to CS: There's a "big target in Canada"; "We will need a good team in Canada"



3

JUNE 6

CS introduces Gupta to UC, the would-be assassin, through electronic messages



7

JUNE 18

Hardeep Singh Nijjar is assassinated in Canada; Yadav sends Gupta a video of his slumped body in car